University Rover Challenge 2024

The University Rover Challenge (URC) tasks student teams with designing and building the next generation of Mars rovers to work alongside astronauts in future explorations of the Red Planet.

The ARTPARK sponsored team, led by Sidak Grewal and comprising over 25 members *(The core team is made up completely of undergraduate students, with PhD students joining in as mentors and advisors*), has successfully developed the mechanical design and long-range communication systems for their rover.

Sidak Grewal, team leader explains: The rover that the IISc team named **"Vicharika** is developing is fitted with an arm capable of performing a wide range of complex mechanical tasks, such as pressing keyboard keys, flipping buttons, lifting objects, and tightening screws. These tools need to be packed into a compact machine and tested in the harsh sandy terrain of the desert. The rover has to be developed in stages within specified deadlines, and the team needs to submit various progress reports and plans at different times.

Mentorship: The team is mentored by Prof. Pushpak Jagtap from the Robert Bosch Centre for Cyber-Physical Systems (RBCCPS), Indian Institute of Science (IISc Bengaluru)

Event Details:

- **Dates:** May 29 - June 1, 2024
- **Location:** Mars Desert Research Station, Hanksville, Utah

